

Sermon outline for March 13 one through eight
November 17th 2024

Sermon Outline for Mark 13:1-8

Focus Statement: Jesus refocuses our attention and vision from human achievements, troubles, and celebrities to focusing on Him and His inbreaking Kingdom.

1. Upsetting the Equilibrium

Personal Opening: Start with a story or experience about AI, perhaps describing a moment where you were impressed or unsettled by the technology. Reflect briefly on how it felt like a glimpse of something world-changing or even apocalyptic.

Local Connection: Mention how, here at Anniston First, we're also working hard on big plans and dreams—like reimagining the sanctuary and making strategic decisions about our future. There's a sense of excitement but also anxiety, similar to how the disciples marveled at the Temple's grandeur.

Political and Cultural Tensions: Transition into the recent presidential election. Reflect on how political leaders have become our modern-day celebrities, dividing our attention and becoming sources of either hope or fear, as if our security depends on them.

2. Analyzing the Problem (Digging into the Text)

Context of Mark 13: Describe the disciples' reaction to the Temple's grandeur and how Jesus unsettles them by prophesying its destruction. The Temple was a massive human achievement, yet Jesus points to its impermanence.

Parallel to Today: We, too, place our trust in achievements, leaders, or technology, thinking they offer security. But just as the Temple couldn't stand forever, no human accomplishment can bring the lasting hope we crave.

3. Owning the Problem (Naming Our Need)

Human Nature: We crave control, security, and stability, and we often look for these things in the wrong places—political figures, AI, or meticulously planned strategies. It's part of our brokenness that we put our trust in what is temporary.

Fear and Anxiety: Address the congregation's fears head-on, especially regarding AI and political division. Acknowledge the real anxiety families feel about the future, whether it's about technology, global instability, or what kind of world their children will inherit.

4. Exploring God's Solution (Introducing Jesus)

"WHAT ARE
AI PRINCE: MY BLIND SPOTS?"
PODCAST: AI FRIENDS.

Jesus' Message: Emphasize how Jesus' teaching in Mark 13 invites us to a different perspective. The Kingdom of God is not threatened by our fears or impressed by our achievements. It is breaking into the world through Jesus, who is our true hope.

Invitation to Repentance and Trust: Jesus calls us to turn away from placing our trust in human power or technology and to refocus on Him. Repentance is about reorienting our vision, not just feeling sorry for misplaced trust.

5. Experiencing the Gospel (The Good News)

Hopeful Vision: Cast a vision of Jesus' unshakeable Kingdom. Share stories or examples of where you see God's Kingdom breaking into the world—through acts of love, community, or moments of grace.

Assurance in Uncertainty: Remind the congregation that no matter how uncertain the world feels—whether because of political turmoil or fears of an AI-driven apocalypse—God's Kingdom is already here, and it's not going anywhere.

6. Bringing It Home (Inviting a Response)

Practical Application: Invite the congregation to examine where they've placed their trust and to make a conscious shift. Suggest spiritual practices, like daily prayers of surrender or practicing Sabbath rest as a way to trust God more deeply.

WELCOME, FEAR
ANGER

Action for Families: Encourage parents and families to refocus their attention on Jesus together, perhaps through shared devotional time or simple, tech-free moments that reconnect them to God's presence.

7. Closing (Restoring the Equilibrium)

Benediction: End with a word of hope, perhaps using a hymn or prayer that points back to Jesus as our firm foundation.

UMH 509 or TURN YOUR EYES - SING

Final Image: Leave them with a simple but profound image of Jesus' Kingdom—unshakable, ever-present, and filled with the grace we so desperately need.

• AI can reveal blind spots, not ♥

• BUT JESUS KNOWS my heart & gives hope.

• ~~AMID~~ TECH, CELEBRITIES & TROUBLES,

JESUS IS OUR UNFADING LIGHT

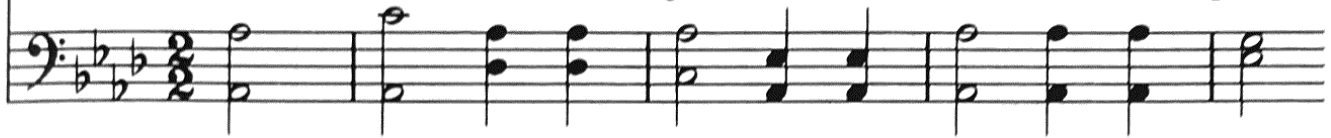
HIS KINGDOM IS UNSHAKABLE, INDESTRUCTABLE
& BREAKING IN!

How Firm a Foundation

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1. How firm a foun - da - tion, ye saints of the Lord,
 2. "Fear not, I am with thee, O be not dis - mayed,
 3. "When through the deep wa - ters I call thee to go,
 4. "When through fi - ery tri - als thy path - ways shall lie,
 5. "The soul that on Je - sus still leans for re - pose,



is laid for your faith in his ex - cel - lent word!
 for I am thy God and will still give thee aid;
 the riv - ers of woe shall not thee o - ver - flow;
 my grace, all - suf - fi - cient, shall be thy sup - ply;
 I will not, I will not de - sert to its foes;



What more can he say than to you he hath said,
 I'll strength - en and help thee, and cause thee to stand
 for I will be with thee, thy trou - bles to bless,
 the flame shall not hurt thee; I on - ly de - sign
 that soul, though all hell should en - deav - or to shake,



to you who for ref - uge to Je - sus have fled?

up - held by my righ-teous, om - ni - po - tent hand.
and sanc - ti - fy to thee thy deep - est dis - tress.
thy dross to con - sume, and thy gold to re - fine.
I'll nev - er, no, nev - er, no, nev - er for - sake."



WORDS: "K" in Rippon's *A Selection of Hymns*, 1787 (2 Tim. 2:19; Heb. 13:5; Is. 43:1-2)
MUSIC: Early USA melody; harm. from *Tabor*, 1866

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